

Grant Govel, RHP, USC

2026 Stats: 2.87 ERA/103.1 IP/.900 WHIP/99 K/16 BB/6.19 K:BB

6-0, 200

Metrics

FB: 91.6/21 IVB/12.1 HB/-4.52 VAA/6.09 relH/6.15 ext/45.3 AA/45.9% zone/51% usage/2360 rpm

CT: 87.1/13.4 IVB/-0.7 HB/-6.08 VAA/40.4 AA/30.9% zone/7.3% usage/2430 rpm

CB: 78.1/-13.7 IVB/-9.8 HB/-9.68 VAA/43.3 AA/38.2% zone/11.4% usage/2550 rpm

SL: 82.7/2.8 IVB/-6.4 HB/-7.92 VAA/39.7 AA/26.4% zone/13.2% usage/2600 rpm

CH: 82.6/10.2 IVB/20.1 HB/-6.97 VAA/32.9 AA/34.4% zone/17.1% usage/2090 rpm

Write-Up

Grant Govel features one of the deeper five-pitch repertoires among college right-handers, attacking hitters with a riding four-seam fastball before mixing four distinct secondaries that each serve a different purpose. Throwing from an over-the-top slot with a quick arm and average extension, Govel creates elite vertical traits on the fastball while generating significant shape separation throughout the arsenal. His ability to manipulate pitch usage depending on handedness stands out, leaning heavily on the changeup against left-handed hitters while incorporating both breaking balls more frequently against righties. The overall profile is that of a strike-throwing starter whose success hinges on continuing to refine the consistency of the secondary arsenal. The other plus aspect of the profile, was his ability to throw innings at USC in 2026, surpassing the 100 frame mark across his 19 appearances (18 starts with one midweek relief appearance). With a legitimate five-pitch mix already in place, there is enough present stuff to project as a professional starter, though sharpening the breaking balls would elevate both the floor and ceiling.

The fastball is the carrying pitch in the profile. Sitting in the low-to-mid 90s with an elite 21 inches of induced vertical break from a high release point, the pitch carries exceptionally well through the top of the strike zone and plays flatter than the velocity would suggest. Govel consistently attacked the upper third against hitters from both sides, generating most of his swing-and-miss above the zone where the

carry simply overpowered barrels. While the average velocity is modest, he has shown the ability to reach the mid-90s, giving the pitch another gear when needed. He commands it confidently, though occasional arm-side misses allow the pitch to leak back over the heart of the plate. The ride and approach angle make it an above-average collegiate heater with room to play as a professional weapon if the command continues to improve. 50/55 pitch

The cutter has evolved into more of a true depth cutter than the firmer carrying version seen previously. Thrown around 87 mph, it features late glove-side bite with minimal depth, allowing it to tunnel well off the fastball before diving out away from barrels. Govel showed confidence throwing it glove-side to right-handed hitters and stealing strikes early in counts, though he rarely featured it against lefties. While the pitch lacks overwhelming chase characteristics, it serves as an effective bridge between the fastball and breaking balls, giving hitters another look in the upper-80s velocity band. Continued refinement of command and confidence against opposite-handed hitters would help round out the offering. 45/50 pitch

The curveball is a true overhand downer with tight 12-to-6 shape generated by above-average spin. The pitch consistently stayed on plane before falling sharply beneath barrels, making it difficult for hitters to identify out of the hand. Govel effectively used it as both a called-strike weapon and a chase pitch, particularly against left-handed hitters where he was comfortable backdooring it early before expanding below the zone with two strikes. Against righties, he more frequently landed it for strikes before burying it once ahead in the count. The depth, spin efficiency, and feel to locate all point toward an above-average breaking ball that projects well moving forward. 50/55 pitch

The slider provides a different look than the curveball, featuring short glove-side movement with above-average depth from the same high release point. Rather than operating as a wipeout pitch, it functions as a harder breaking ball that can be landed for strikes before expanding just off the plate. The shape varied at times throughout the season, occasionally losing some depth, but it consistently maintained enough separation from the curveball to give hitters another velocity band to account for. Increased consistency and a slightly firmer version would allow the pitch to better complement the rest of the arsenal. 45/50 pitch

The changeup loudly rounds out the repertoire as one of Govel's best secondaries. Featuring heavy arm-side fade with over 20 inches of horizontal movement and nearly a 10 mph separation off the fastball, it consistently generated uncomfortable swings from left-handed hitters. He threw it aggressively with conviction, locating it down and away while maintaining excellent arm speed. The pitch produced outstanding chase and swing-and-miss numbers thanks to the combination of movement and location, and he demonstrated the confidence to throw it in any count. Against left-handed hitters, it often functioned as the primary put-away pitch, while versus righties it served as a quality change-of-pace offering to keep hitters from sitting on elevated fastballs. The shape and command give it legitimate plus potential. 55/60 pitch